encompassing the disservices (such as disease) as well as the services. Some of the natural processes most important to the continuation of human life can be classified as ecosystem services, such as pollination of crops, decomposition of waste, and the availability of clean drinking water. Ecologists argue that because the enormous contributions of ecosystem services to human life are not readily quantifiable, humans drastically undervalue these services while exploiting the natural world's resources for profit. Although the idea that humans benefit from nature has a long history, it was not until the 1970s that the balance between nature and human needs came to the forefront of ecological debate. The term ecosystem services was first used in the mid-1980s, and in 1997 the idea was developed in two key articles: "Ecosystem Services: Benefits Supplied to Human Societies by Natural Ecosystems," edited by Gretchen Daily, and "The Value of the World's Ecosystem Services and Natural Capital," edited by US ecological economist Robert Costanza. In 2001, UN Secretary General Kofi Annan launched the Millennium Ecosystem Assessment (MEA), which helped popularize the concept of ecosystem services in 2005, when it published a wide-ranging appraisal of how humans impact the environment.